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C1000-189 Exam

IBM Instana Observability v1.0.277 Administrator - Professional

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Question 1. (Multi Select)

Which two thresholds can be chosen in Advanced Mode when setting up a Smart Alert?

A: Single
B: Static
C: Progressive
D: Adaptive
E: Neutral

Correct Answer: B, D

Explanation:

Instana Smart Alerts provide intelligent, context-aware alerting capabilities. In Advanced Mode, administrators can choose between two distinct threshold types: Static and Adaptive. The IBM Instana documentation details: "Advanced Mode supports both static and adaptive thresholds, letting users define explicit limit values or rely on adaptive baselines derived from historical data." Static thresholds are fixed, user-defined values best suited for predictable workloads or regulatory uptime scenarios. Adaptive thresholds use machine learning on time-series historical behavior to automatically adjust boundaries when traffic patterns or operating baselines change. This significantly reduces false positives and ensures that alerts reflect true anomalies rather than normal variance. Both threshold types can trigger multi-level alerts and integrate with escalation policies. Static measures remain critical for SLIs requiring consistent control, while adaptive techniques optimize monitoring of microservices under fluctuating loads. IBM emphasizes combining these in practice to balance detected sensitivity across mixed systems, leveraging AI-driven dynamic configurations in adaptive mode as a key differentiator in its observability platform.

Question 2. (Single Select)

Which data source on the analytics page shows traces?

A: Infrastructure

B: Applications
C: Logs
D: Websites

Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Instana's Analytics page provides a consolidated environment for users to query and visualize operational data across their stack. According to the official IBM Instana Observability documentation, traces—comprising the end-to-end journey of requests across services—are found specifically under the Applications data source. The Applications section gives interactive access to traces, requests, response times, call hierarchies, and distributed dependencies. This is possible because Instana's agent and tracers automatically instrument applications to capture and send detailed trace data. The documentation states, "The Applications analytics section allows you to interactively work with service traces and requests, providing distributed tracing visibility." This allows users to drill down, identify bottlenecks, and analyze errors at the service interaction and code execution level.

Infrastructure data source focuses on system-level metrics (CPU, memory, disk), Logs cover textual/semi-structured log output, and Websites relate to synthetic and real-user measurements—but only Applications feature distributed tracing as per the IBM Instana Observability product documentation. Thus, for incident response, root-cause analysis, and performance breakdowns, always consult the Applications data source for trace-level data.

Question 3. (Single Select)

How can OTLP be enabled?

A: By configuring multiple tracers
B: In the settings.hcl
C: In the params.yaml
D: Using Helm

Correct Answer: D

Explanation:

OTLP (OpenTelemetry Protocol) enables modern, standards-based telemetry with Instana for traces and metrics. The official IBM Instana documentation explains that enabling OTLP support should be done during installation or upgrade via Helm, using either values set in a YAML file or via the --set command line argument. This method is described as, "To enable OTLP, use Helm with the provided chart and set OTLP values in your values.yaml or with the --set flag." Helm automation allows administrators to easily manage, update, and version-control agent and collector configuration at scale—especially in Kubernetes environments. It is favored because it is compatible with Instana's operator and dynamic config approaches. Manual edits in settings.hcl or params.yaml are not recommended or officially documented for enabling OTLP streams. Multiple tracers relate to instrumentation and are not for enabling the protocol itself. Using Helm provides a streamlined, repeatable and supported approach – per IBM Instana deployment best practices.

Question 4. (Single Select)

Which language is primarily used for writing Synthetic monitoring API scripts in Instana?

A: Java
B: JavaScript
C: Python
D: Go

Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Instana's Synthetic Monitoring module allows administrators to script user journeys and API checks to validate service performance and uptime. According to official IBM documentation, "Synthetic monitoring API scripts use JavaScript as the scripting language for configuring user flows and custom API tests." Instana has designed its synthetic user interface to interpret JavaScript natively which provides powerful, flexible constructs for simulating user interactions, custom API payloads, test logic, and error handling. This ensures broad compatibility with real browser environments and highly customizable synthetic scenarios. Java, Python, and Go are not supported for browser-based or synthetic API scripting in Instana's synthetic monitors. JavaScript is chosen for its ubiquity and ease of integration with DOM-like and API interaction

patterns, supporting the most common web-based automation needs as described in the documentation.

Question 5. (Single Select)

For Instana Standard Edition, in which file should the salesKey be updated?

A: config.yaml
B: license.json
C: download.pl
D: Gui.api

Correct Answer: B

Explanation:

Licensing in Instana is controlled by a key called "salesKey," which must be placed in the license.json file for Standard Edition. Per IBM Instana Observability documentation, "The salesKey is part of the license.json file, which must be updated to activate the Instana Standard Edition license." This file is checked at startup and authorizes agent/server deployment, binding entitlement and features to the account. Instana's licensing model relies on proper key management within license.json for compliance and support tracking. The config.yaml file manages agent technical configuration, not licensing. Download.pl and gui.api files are not associated with salesKey or licensing. Any update to the license must be done within license.json and validated by Instana's backend for activation completeness—this procedure is outlined step-by-step in the installation and onboarding guides.

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